What does a formula tell us?

Which elements there are and how many atoms of each

H_2O

H and **O** are the **symbols** of the elements: hydrogen and oxygen.

The small number at the bottom (**subscript**) tells how many atoms there are: **2** of H.

If a symbol has **no number**, there is **1** atom: 1 of O.



H_2O: 2 H and 1 O



CO_2: 1 C and 2 O



Fe_2O_3: 2 Fe and 3 O